

Suspend Your Notebook

 Booting the notebook when it is not connected to a power source draws a lot of power from the battery. Instead of shutting down your laptop in the middle of a meeting, choose the suspend mode if you wish to use it again after a short period of time.

Entertainment Is Bad For Your Battery

 Playing graphics intensive games, videos or music drains the battery quickly. Close any such applications when on battery to prolong battery life.

ACCESSORIES

Carry Safe

 A good carry case is essential for your notebook. There are a variety of options available. Choose one that fits your requirements and budget.

Apart from being sturdy, you should opt for one that has a padded shoulder strap and has enough space to hold additional stuff such as the power adaptor, CDs, papers, external drives, mouse and cell phone. Some notebook bags also double-up as overnighters.

Get A Mouse

 Users who do not find the notebook touchpad easy to use should opt for an external mouse. Though you can use a standard desktop mouse with your laptop,



specially-designed notebook mice are available. These are smaller in size and easy to carry around. Some even come with retractable cords to reduce the jumble of wires you need to carry. You can also opt for a wireless mouse. Most of the newer ones use the USB interface, so make

sure you have a free USB port on your notebook.

Go The Desktop Route

 Those who use their notebooks as their primary computer may want to invest in an external keyboard, mouse and even a larger monitor. This will be the closest to the feel of a standard desktop.

Additional Connectivity

 Some notebook models can be hooked up to compatible port replicators and docking stations. These devices allow for added functionality by providing additional ports and external drives.

Must-Have

 A USB thumb drive is a useful little piece of



hardware for transferring small amounts of data between computers. These come in handy in situations where, for instance, you would like to transfer a presentation or a sales proposal to your client's PC at his office. Some USB

drives come with password protection option and provide a safe place to store confidential files. Instead of storing these files on the notebook hard drive, just carry them with you in the USB drive. You can work on them directly once the drive is connected. This way, your confidential files do not find their way into the hands of crooks even if your notebook gets stolen.

More Power

 An extra battery pack is a good investment if you plan to stay away from a power socket for long.

When In Rome...

 Different countries have different types of power sockets. Accordingly, check and carry the appropriate type. If you are a global traveller, opt for a universal adaptor. It offers a variety of



different plug types allowing you to connect your notebook power adaptor to power sockets almost anywhere in the world.

Stop Thief!

 Invest in a Kensington lock to prevent your notebook from being stolen. A Kensington lock features a strong cord that can be looped around the leg of a table or chair and then locks onto a slot in the notebook, thus preventing anyone from walking away with the device.



Some of the higher-end lock models also boast of motion sensors and emit high-pitched beeps if any motion is detected.

Enjoy The Trip

 If you enjoy movies and music on the notebook and find the integrated speakers to be good enough, you may purchase external speakers specially designed for notebook users. These are extremely compact and easy to carry. Most draw power from the notebook or from their own set of batteries.



These speakers may not offer the surround sound experience, but will definitely sound better than most integrated laptop speakers. However, if you like to watch a movie or listen to music while travelling in an airplane or a train, it makes sense to buy a decent set of headphones

so as not to disturb your fellow travellers.

Store More

 An external hard drive is a good option if you want to carry large files without stuffing your notebook's hard drive.

Charge Your Cell Phone From The Laptop

 If you are a cell phone junkie and find that your cell phone battery is not able to give you enough juice, buy a USB charger for your phone. These are useful for people who stay on the road for the better part of the day and are not able to access a power socket to charge their cell phones.

USB chargers are available for most commonly available cell phone brands and draw power from your notebook's USB port to charge the cell phone.

However, this will also shorten your notebook battery life, so make sure your notebook battery is charged enough to see you through till the time you can connect it to a power socket again.

Increase The Number Of USB Ports

 If you do not have enough USB ports on your laptop to connect all your devices, opt for a USB hub.

Light It Up

 A keyboard light is a good buy for those who want to work on their notebooks without disturbing their neighbours in a long-haul flight or their spouses in the bedroom. The light clips on to the top of the notebook screen, draws power from the USB port, and illuminates the keyboard so that you can work in the dark.

Additional Stuff

 A range of accessories including battery packs, Wi-Fi PC cards, USB to Wi-Fi adaptors, USB to Bluetooth adaptors, external optical drives and notebook coolers are available. Explore local dealers and online stores, and you are sure to find what you are looking for. 